



NO. 1 OF 16

Remy Quill

THE ART DEALER

“You know what everything in this room is worth. Tonight, that includes a secret.”

FOR REMY QUILL'S EYES ONLY

CORE CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A charcoal three-piece suit, a peacock-blue silk tie, white evening gloves and a peacock-feather lapel pin.

MASK: Peacock (or any blue-green mask)

DRESS STYLE

A peacock-blue beaded dress, long white evening gloves and a peacock-feather pin or hair clip.

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You run Quill Fine Art on Harbor Street. Three years ago you sold Gus Whitlock three seascapes by the late harbour painter Elias Thorne, for a great deal of money. They hang in the club gallery. Tonight you wear a peacock mask, and your coat-check ticket is No. 3.

YOUR SECRET: YOU POISONED GUS

The three “Thorne” seascapes are copies. You had them painted and sold them to Gus as genuine. Last week Gus hired an expert, and he told you he would name you in front of the whole town at midnight. So you made a plan.

- ◆ Charlie Ashby’s column printed a sketch of Charlie’s silver fox mask. You had Delacroix Theatrical Supply copy it exactly, and paid in cash.
- ◆ At 8:40 pm you borrowed the greenhouse key “to sketch the orchids” and snapped off two foxglove stalks. Your gloves were stained green, so you rolled them into your portfolio case at the cloakroom and put on your spare pair.
- ◆ At 11:52 you swapped your peacock mask for the fox in the service corridor. At 11:55 you lifted Gus’s gold-rimmed coupe from Dana’s tray (“I’ll take the host his glass”), tipped in the foxglove drops and handed it to him.
- ◆ At 11:57 you slipped back into the corridor and at 11:58 unscrewed a fuse. In the dark you pushed the fox mask into the potted palm and came back as the peacock.

You did it. Keep it secret.

Your cover story:

at 11:55 you were in the crowd at the champagne tower in your peacock mask, and you never left the ballroom. You may lie about anything except what is printed on an evidence card. Never confess until the Inspector reads the solution.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Be gracious and shocked. Agree it must have been the silver fox at the tower, and remind everyone that the whole town knows Charlie Ashby is the fox. Mention that Charlie had a nasty column about Gus ready to print. If anyone asks about the seascapes: Gus adored them, and you are proud of the sale.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

The expert's telegram is out. Stay calm: "Experts disagree all the time. I bought them in good faith from a private collection." About the greenhouse book: you went in to sketch the orchids and touched nothing. Point at Sidney, who also went into the greenhouse, and at Jordan and Morgan, who both lose money if the club is sold.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

Say someone used your name: "Anyone can say 'R. Quill' at a shop counter." About the gloves: half the room wears white gloves, and anyone can open a case at the cloakroom. Peacock feathers are everywhere tonight. Keep steering people toward Charlie. On your ballot, accuse someone else.

Notes & suspects

PLAYING REMY

Your manner: Smooth, charming and a little superior. Admire everyone's costume, talk about "provenance" and "good taste", and never raise your voice.

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you. Accuse someone else.

Suspect quick list (public information only)

NAME	ROLE	TALK OF THE PARTY
Remy Quill	The Art Dealer	Sold Gus the seascapes in his gallery
Avery Lark	The Resident Singer	Contract about to be cancelled by Gus
Jordan Pierce	The Club Partner	Would lose everything if the club was sold
Sidney Hart	Gus's Ward and Heir	Named in Gus's new will
Morgan Bellamy	Owner of The Gilded Owl	Gus's business rival
Frankie Dade	The Bandleader	Owes Gus a large sum of money
Charlie Ashby	The Society Columnist	Wore the silver fox mask; had a column about Gus
Dana Rook	The Caterer	In charge of the champagne tower
Leslie Croft	Gus's Lawyer	Knows exactly what the new will says
Billie Sable	The Coat-Check Attendant	Saw who came and went from the cloakroom
Robin Vale	The Aviator	Lost a fortune in Gus's air-mail company
Jesse Monroe	The Photographer	Took the 11:55 photograph
Kit Haverford	The Shipping Heir	Broke off an engagement to Gus
Taylor Moss	The Stage Magician	Knows how to make the lights go out
Emery Fontaine	The Dance Instructor	Not on the dance floor at 11:58
Marion Kettle	The Club Chef	Keeps the greenhouse key in the kitchen
Inspector Sloane Whitaker	The host	Running the investigation
Augustus "Gus" Whitlock	The victim	Owner of the Blue Lantern Club



NO. 2 OF 16

Avery Lark

THE RESIDENT SINGER

“Every night at the Blue Lantern ends with your song. Tonight, someone wrote a different ending.”

FOR AVERY LARK'S EYES ONLY

CORE CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A midnight-blue tuxedo with satin lapels, a silver bow tie and a sparkly lapel pin.

MASK: White swan

DRESS STYLE

A sequined drop-waist dress, a long string of pearls and a feathered headband.

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PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You have sung at the Blue Lantern every Friday and Saturday for six years. At 11:50 pm tonight you began your closing number, “Midnight Moon”, on the bandstand under the spotlight, with Frankie Dade’s band behind you. You wear a white swan mask.

YOUR SECRET

At 9:30 Gus called you into his office and told you your contract ends this month: a big-city singer is coming to replace you. You said, “You’ll regret this, Gus,” loud enough for the cloakroom to hear. At 11:20 you slipped into the service corridor behind the bandstand to cry where nobody could see, and you were back on stage for the 11:30 Last Waltz.

You are innocent

From 11:50 until the lights went out at 11:58 you were on the bandstand in the spotlight, singing. The whole room was looking at you.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING AVERY

Your manner: Glamorous, warm and a little dramatic. Hum a few bars when you are nervous, call everyone “darling” and remember you are the star of this room.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Act shaken: you were mid-song when the room went dark. Share what you saw from the bandstand at 11:55: a guest in a silver fox mask handed Gus his gold-rimmed coupe at the champagne tower. Keep the corridor to yourself for now; if anyone mentions the contract, brush it off.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

Admit the contract news if asked, with dignity. Share something else you saw from the stage: at about 11:57 the silver fox walked away from the tower and through the service corridor door, just before the lights went out. When the lights came back, there was no silver fox anywhere in the ballroom.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

If anyone mentions the corridor, admit you were there at 11:20, alone and upset. You never touched the fuse box: you were back on stage for the Last Waltz at 11:30, and singing at 11:58. Ask who else had a reason to fear Gus's midnight announcement.

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

Suspect quick list (public information only)

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Billie Sable	The Coat-Check Attendant	Saw who came and went from the cloakroom
Robin Vale	The Aviator	Lost a fortune in Gus's air-mail company
Jesse Monroe	The Photographer	Took the 11:55 photograph
Kit Haverford	The Shipping Heir	Broke off an engagement to Gus
Taylor Moss	The Stage Magician	Knows how to make the lights go out
Emery Fontaine	The Dance Instructor	Not on the dance floor at 11:58
Marion Kettle	The Club Chef	Keeps the greenhouse key in the kitchen
Inspector Sloane Whitaker	The host	Running the investigation
Augustus "Gus" Whitlock	The victim	Owner of the Blue Lantern Club



NO. 3 OF 16

Jordan Pierce

THE CLUB PARTNER

“Twelve years of hard work, and Gus wanted to sell it all at midnight.”

FOR JORDAN PIERCE'S EYES ONLY

CORE CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A black dinner jacket, a gold waistcoat, a pocket watch and slicked-back hair.

MASK: Gold moon

DRESS STYLE

A gold fringe dress, a black velvet wrap and a pocket watch on a long chain.

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PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You and Gus opened the Blue Lantern together twelve years ago. Gus owns most of it; you own a small share and do most of the work. Tonight you have been checking on the staff, the band and the door. You wear a gold moon mask.

YOUR SECRET

This morning Gus told you he was selling the club to the Harbor Hotel Company. Under the deal your share is worth almost nothing, and the staff lose their jobs. At 11:00 you argued with Gus in the gallery (“You’ll ruin us both!”) and people heard. At 11:50 you went up to the balcony with Morgan Bellamy, your old rival, to discuss buying the club yourselves with Morgan’s money.

You are innocent

From 11:50 until the lights went out you were on the balcony with Morgan Bellamy, in full view of the bandstand.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING JORDAN

Your manner: Brisk, protective and in charge. Check your pocket watch, count heads and keep reminding everyone that this is your club too.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Take charge: nobody leaves, and everybody stays calm. If anyone heard the 11:00 argument, say it was “about the accounts”. Keep the balcony meeting private for now. Ask Dana who carried Gus his glass, and ask Charlie Ashby where the silver fox was at 11:55.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

The waiter’s slip puts you on the balcony with Morgan. Admit the meeting, and admit that Gus was selling the club. Point out that nobody can be on the balcony and at the champagne tower at the same time.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

Gus’s midnight card proves the sale. Say: “Yes, I would have lost my share. But Gus alive was my only chance to change his mind.” Then ask who else that card was about, and why Gus wanted to make it public.

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

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NO. 4 OF 16

Sidney Hart

GUS'S WARD AND HEIR

"The Blue Lantern is the only home you have ever known."

FOR SIDNEY HART'S EYES ONLY

CORE CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A tweed jacket, a cream sweater vest, a bow tie and a flower in the buttonhole.

MASK: Owl

DRESS STYLE

A pale green tea dress, a cardigan, round spectacles and a lily corsage.

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PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You were ten when Gus, your godparent, took you in. You grew up in the rooms above the club, and now you study botany at the college across the bay. Tonight you wear an owl mask.

YOUR SECRET

Last week Gus's lawyer told you Gus had changed his will: the Blue Lantern goes to you, unless it is sold before Gus dies. If Gus had sold the club tonight, you would have got nothing. At 10:30 you went into the greenhouse to pick lilies for your corsage, and as a botanist you know exactly what foxglove looks like.

You are innocent

From 11:45 until the lights went out you sat at table 4, beside the champagne tower, watching card tricks with a crowd of guests. You never wore a fox mask.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING SIDNEY

Your manner: Earnest, bookish and protective of Gus's memory. Fiddle with your corsage and gently correct anyone who gets a plant name wrong.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Be shaken: Gus was the only family you had. Defend Gus's good name. Ask Charlie Ashby what the column about Gus was going to say, and ask Jordan whether Gus had been worried about anything lately.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

Your name is in the greenhouse book at 10:30. Explain: lilies for your corsage. Share what you noticed as a botanist: two foxglove stalks were already snapped off when you got there, and the broken stems had dried. Whoever took them went in well before you.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

The new will is out. Admit you knew. "If Gus sold the club, I lost it. I wanted the sale stopped, not Gus gone." Point out that the foxglove was gone before 10:15, and your owl mask never left your face.

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

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Augustus "Gus" Whitlock	The victim	Owner of the Blue Lantern Club



NO. 5 OF 16

Morgan Bellamy

OWNER OF THE GILDED OWL

“Your oldest rival is gone. Funny how nobody looks at you kindly.”

FOR MORGAN BELLAMY’S EYES ONLY

CORE CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A white dinner jacket, a black bow tie and a gold star pin.

MASK: Gold star

DRESS STYLE

A black-and-gold beaded gown, long gloves and a star hair clip.

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You own The Gilded Owl, the other supper club on the harbour. You and Gus have competed for every band, every singer and every guest in Gull Harbor for ten years. Gus invited you tonight, which surprised everyone, including you. You wear a gold star mask.

YOUR SECRET

You heard that the Harbor Hotel Company was buying the Blue Lantern to turn it into a giant ballroom that would empty your club. You came to stop that deal. At 11:50 you met Jordan Pierce on the balcony and offered your money so that Jordan could buy Gus out instead. Last month you also tried to hire Avery Lark away, and Gus found out.

You are innocent

From 11:50 until the lights went out you were on the balcony with Jordan Pierce, in full view of the bandstand.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING MORGAN

Your manner: Sharp, witty and competitive. Compare everything to your own club (“At the Gilded Owl, the band is better”).

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Play it cool: “I came for the music and the competition.” Admit that you and Gus were rivals; everyone knows it. Keep the balcony meeting secret for now. Ask Avery whether Gus had been unkind lately.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

The waiter’s slip is out. Admit the balcony meeting with Jordan and explain your offer. Point out that you needed Gus alive and willing to sell to Jordan. A dead man signs nothing.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

Ask who gains if Gus’s midnight card is never read aloud. The hotel deal is dead now, but so is the rest of Gus’s announcement. Ask the room: who was Gus going to name?

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

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Suspect quick list (public information only)

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NO. 6 OF 16

Frankie Dade

THE BANDLEADER

“The band plays on, whatever happens. Even in the dark.”

FOR FRANKIE DADE'S EYES ONLY

CORE CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A pinstripe suit, two-tone shoes, a skinny tie and a conductor's baton.

DRESS STYLE

A dark velvet dress, a pinstripe jacket over the shoulders and a conductor's baton.

MASK: Plain black (the band)

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You lead the eight-piece Blue Lantern Orchestra. From the bandstand you can see the whole ballroom and the balcony above it. The service corridor, with the fuse box, runs right behind the bandstand.

YOUR SECRET

Two years ago Gus lent you \$2,000 to replace the band's instruments after a fire. You still owe most of it, and last week Gus wrote that he wanted every cent back by Christmas or he would keep the instruments. You also know the club's wiring: you fixed the stage lights last spring.

You are innocent

You conducted the band on the bandstand from 11:30 until the lights went out, in front of the whole room.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING FRANKIE

Your manner: Easygoing, musical and full of stories. Tap rhythms on the tables and use plenty of jazz slang ("swell", "the bee's knees", "the cat's pyjamas").

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Be the calm one: “Lights go out, the band plays on. That’s the rule.” Share what you saw from the bandstand: from 11:50 Jordan Pierce and Morgan Bellamy were up on the balcony, deep in conversation, and they were still there when the lights went out.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

Admit the debt if asked. Share what you heard: a few seconds after the lights went out, the service corridor door right behind you banged shut. Somebody had been in that corridor.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

Admit you know the wiring. But point out that a fuse unscrewed by hand needs no skill at all. Ask: who walked past the bandstand toward the corridor just before midnight?

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

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NO. 7 OF 16

Charlie Ashby

THE SOCIETY COLUMNIST

“Everyone knows the silver fox. That is exactly the problem.”

FOR CHARLIE ASHBY'S EYES ONLY

CORE CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A grey suit, a fedora with a press card in the band, and a notebook.

MASK: Silver fox (or any silver mask)

DRESS STYLE

A grey drop-waist dress, a cloche hat, a press card and a notebook.

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You write “Harbor Lights”, the Gazette’s society column. Last Saturday you told your readers you would attend tonight as a silver fox, with a little sketch of the mask. Every guest knows who the fox is.

YOUR SECRET

In your pocket is a column for Monday’s paper: Gus is secretly selling the Blue Lantern to the Harbor Hotel Company, and the staff will lose their jobs. Gus found out at 10:00 and threatened to sue the Gazette. At 11:50 you slipped out to the lobby telephone booth to read the column to the night desk before midnight. Your mask fogged up, so you took it off in the booth.

You are innocent

From 11:51 to 11:59 you were in the lobby telephone booth, on the line to the Gazette. You hung up just after the lights went out.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING CHARLIE

Your manner: Nosy, quick and delighted by scandal. Scribble in your notebook, and say “off the record, darling” whenever you want someone to tell you more.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Everyone will stare at you, because you are the fox. Be indignant: “I was nowhere near that tower!” But a good columnist protects a story, so don’t say where you were yet. Ask Dana exactly who took Gus’s glass from the tray.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

The telephone slip proves it: you were in the lobby booth from 11:51 to 11:59. Explain the column. Then make the point out loud: somebody else was wearing a silver fox mask at 11:55. Ask the room: who else knew what your mask looked like? (Anyone who read your column.)

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

If pressed, read out the part of your column about the sale. Then ask the room who went shopping at Delacroix Theatrical Supply this month.

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

Suspect quick list (public information only)

NAME	ROLE	TALK OF THE PARTY
Remy Quill	The Art Dealer	Sold Gus the seascapes in his gallery
Avery Lark	The Resident Singer	Contract about to be cancelled by Gus
Jordan Pierce	The Club Partner	Would lose everything if the club was sold
Sidney Hart	Gus's Ward and Heir	Named in Gus's new will
Morgan Bellamy	Owner of The Gilded Owl	Gus's business rival
Frankie Dade	The Bandleader	Owes Gus a large sum of money
Charlie Ashby	The Society Columnist	Wore the silver fox mask; had a column about Gus
Dana Rook	The Caterer	In charge of the champagne tower
Leslie Croft	Gus's Lawyer	Knows exactly what the new will says
Billie Sable	The Coat-Check Attendant	Saw who came and went from the cloakroom
Robin Vale	The Aviator	Lost a fortune in Gus's air-mail company
Jesse Monroe	The Photographer	Took the 11:55 photograph
Kit Haverford	The Shipping Heir	Broke off an engagement to Gus
Taylor Moss	The Stage Magician	Knows how to make the lights go out
Emery Fontaine	The Dance Instructor	Not on the dance floor at 11:58
Marion Kettle	The Club Chef	Keeps the greenhouse key in the kitchen
Inspector Sloane Whitaker	The host	Running the investigation
Augustus "Gus" Whitlock	The victim	Owner of the Blue Lantern Club



NO. 8 OF 16

Dana Rook

THE CATERER

“Sixty coupes, one tower and one glass that mattered.”

FOR DANA ROOK'S EYES ONLY

CORE CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A white waiter's jacket, black trousers, a bow tie and a silver tray.

MASK: Black cat

DRESS STYLE

A black dress, a white apron, a bow at the collar and a silver tray.

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

Your firm, Rook Catering, supplies the Blue Lantern's food and drink. Tonight you built the champagne tower, sixty coupes high, and poured it at 11:55. Gus only ever drinks from his own gold-rimmed coupe, which you keep on a silver tray beside the tower. You wear a black cat mask.

YOUR SECRET

Gus owes you three months of bills, and this week he said he would switch to a cheaper supplier in the new year. You were furious. Also, the "bootleg champagne" in the tower is half sparkling cider, to save money. Gus never noticed.

You are innocent

At 11:55 you were behind the tower pouring for the guests, in full view, and you stayed there until the lights went out.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING DANA

Your manner: Busy, proud and practical. Straighten glasses, wipe imaginary spills and take any complaint about the drinks very personally.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Share exactly what you saw at 11:55: you filled Gus's gold-rimmed coupe and set it on your tray. A guest in a silver fox mask stepped up, said "I'll take the host his glass", lifted it off the tray and carried it to Gus. You stayed behind the tower pouring for everyone else.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

Admit the unpaid bills if asked. Point out that every coupe on the tower was clean (Evidence 3). Add: the fox at the tower spoke smoothly and quietly, nothing like Charlie Ashby's usual chatter.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

Confess about the sparkling cider if it comes up, and laugh: "I'd never hurt a customer. I'd only short-change one." Ask whether the photographer caught the fox on film.

Notes & suspects



YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

Suspect quick list (public information only)

NAME	ROLE	TALK OF THE PARTY
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Emery Fontaine	The Dance Instructor	Not on the dance floor at 11:58
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Inspector Sloane Whitaker	The host	Running the investigation
Augustus "Gus" Whitlock	The victim	Owner of the Blue Lantern Club



NO. 9 OF 16

Leslie Croft

GUS'S LAWYER

"You know what is in the will. Everyone wants to know what you know."

FOR LESLIE CROFT'S EYES ONLY

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A dark three-piece suit, wire spectacles and a leather briefcase.

DRESS STYLE

A tailored skirt suit, a high-collared blouse, wire spectacles and a briefcase.

MASK: Plain black

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read "Before the game".

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1-3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You have been Gus's lawyer for twenty years. You draw up every contract the Blue Lantern signs, including the papers for the sale to the Harbor Hotel Company, ready for Gus to sign on Monday.

YOUR SECRET

Last week you rewrote Gus's will: the club goes to Sidney Hart, unless it is sold first. You told Sidney about it, which you should never have done. Gus found out this afternoon and said he would find a new lawyer on Monday.

You are innocent

At 11:55 you stood in the crowd at the champagne tower beside Robin Vale, and you never went near the corridor.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING LESLIE

Your manner: Precise, dry and careful with every word. Say "allegedly" and "I couldn't possibly comment" as often as you can.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Remind everyone you cannot discuss client business. Share one thing: at 9:00 Gus showed you a little card for his midnight speech and tapped the words “not genuine”. He wouldn’t say what they meant.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

Back up Robin Vale: the two of you were side by side at the tower at 11:55. Quietly ask Sidney Hart whether anyone else knows about the will.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

The will is on the evidence table. Admit you told Sidney. Explain the clause: if the club had been sold first, the money would have gone to the Lifeboat Fund. Ask who gains if Gus never reads that card.

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

Suspect quick list (public information only)

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Taylor Moss	The Stage Magician	Knows how to make the lights go out
Emery Fontaine	The Dance Instructor	Not on the dance floor at 11:58
Marion Kettle	The Club Chef	Keeps the greenhouse key in the kitchen
Inspector Sloane Whitaker	The host	Running the investigation
Augustus "Gus" Whitlock	The victim	Owner of the Blue Lantern Club



NO. 10 OF 16

Billie Sable

THE COAT-CHECK ATTENDANT

“Every coat, every mask, every face. You saw them all.”

FOR BILLIE SABLE’S EYES ONLY

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A burgundy bellhop-style jacket with brass buttons and a pillbox cap.

MASK: Plain black (staff)

DRESS STYLE

A burgundy uniform dress with brass buttons and a pillbox cap.

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You run the coat-check counter in the lobby. You took every coat, bag and case tonight, and you handed out the masks from Marigold Costume House against numbered tickets.

YOUR SECRET

For a year you have been selling little bits of gossip to Charlie Ashby's column, a dollar a tip. Gus found out last week and told you that you would be let go after tonight.

You are innocent

You stayed behind the coat-check counter all night. From there you can see the lobby telephone booth.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING BILLIE

Your manner: Quick, cheeky and observant. Remember everyone's ticket number and everyone's coat.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Be helpful. Share: from your counter you could see Charlie Ashby in the lobby telephone booth from about 11:50 until the lights went out, mask off, talking non-stop.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

Share: at 11:45 the guest with ticket No. 3 came to your counter, opened a leather portfolio case, took something small out and walked back toward the ballroom, on the bandstand side.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

Share: just after the lights came back, you saw a guest in a peacock mask come through from the bandstand side, pulling on a glove. If anyone asks about the gossip, admit it with a shrug.

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

Suspect quick list (public information only)

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Inspector Sloane Whitaker	The host	Running the investigation
Augustus "Gus" Whitlock	The victim	Owner of the Blue Lantern Club



NO. 11 OF 16

Robin Vale

THE AVIATOR

“You have flown across oceans. Tonight you cannot get out of one room.”

FOR ROBIN VALE’S EYES ONLY

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A leather flying jacket over evening wear, a silk scarf and goggles on your head.

MASK: Falcon (or any brown mask)

DRESS STYLE

A leather flying jacket over a beaded dress, a silk scarf and goggles.

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You flew the first air-mail route out of Gull Harbor. Two years ago Gus talked you into putting your savings into the Gull Harbor Air Mail Company.

YOUR SECRET

The company failed in the spring, and Gus kept the last of the money. Tonight you planned to stand up at midnight and demand it back in front of everyone. You keep telling people you will fly to Paris next year, but you cannot afford the fuel.

You are innocent

At 11:55 you were at the champagne tower beside Leslie Croft, coupe in hand.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING ROBIN

Your manner: Bold, restless and full of flying stories. Check the weather through the window and call everyone “chum”.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Tell a flying story or two. Share what you saw at 11:57: a guest in a silver fox mask slipping through the service corridor door.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

Share: at 11:59, just after the lights came back, Charlie Ashby walked in from the lobby with the fox mask in hand. So the fox you saw at 11:57 could not have been Charlie.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

Admit the lost money if pressed: “I wanted my money back, not Gus gone. Who pays me now?” Back up Leslie: you were side by side at 11:55.

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

Suspect quick list (public information only)

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Inspector Sloane Whitaker	The host	Running the investigation
Augustus "Gus" Whitlock	The victim	Owner of the Blue Lantern Club



NO. 12 OF 16

Jesse Monroe

THE PHOTOGRAPHER

“One flash, one photograph, and one guest who did not want it taken.”

FOR JESSE MONROE'S EYES ONLY

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A flat cap, braces, rolled shirtsleeves and a camera on a strap.

MASK: Plain silver

DRESS STYLE

A flat cap, a long cardigan over a simple dress, and a camera on a strap.

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

Gus hired you to photograph the masquerade for the club scrapbook. At 11:55 you took a flash picture of Gus at the champagne tower.

YOUR SECRET

Gus never paid you for last year's photographs, and tonight he said he never would. Worse, at 11:00 you photographed Jordan Pierce and Gus arguing in the gallery, and you planned to sell the picture to the Gazette.

You are innocent

At 11:55 you were behind your camera, ten feet from the tower, taking the photograph everyone is now talking about.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING JESSE

Your manner: Eager, a little nervous and always framing a shot. Ask people to “hold that pose”.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Tell people you took a photograph at 11:55 and the film is being developed. Ask who was standing nearest to Gus.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

Share a detail you remember from the flash: the silver fox at the tower wore a tiny peacock-feather pin on the lapel.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

The photograph is out (Evidence 17). Ask everyone who was wearing a peacock-feather pin tonight. Admit the unpaid bill and the gallery photo if asked.

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

Suspect quick list (public information only)

NAME	ROLE	TALK OF THE PARTY
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Inspector Sloane Whitaker	The host	Running the investigation
Augustus "Gus" Whitlock	The victim	Owner of the Blue Lantern Club



NO. 13 OF 16

Kit Haverford

THE SHIPPING HEIR

“You said no to Gus once. Some people never forgot it.”

FOR KIT HAVERFORD'S EYES ONLY

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A cream linen suit, a silk cravat and a gold signet ring.

MASK: Butterfly

DRESS STYLE

A cream silk dress, long pearls and a velvet evening wrap.

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

Your family owns the Haverford shipping line. Five years ago you and Gus were engaged, and then you broke it off. You have stayed polite ever since.

YOUR SECRET

Gus still has your grandmother's pearl brooch, lent to him before the engagement ended, and he refused to give it back. Tonight you planned to take it from his office while everyone watched the unmasking.

You are innocent

At 11:55 you were in the lobby, fixing your mask at the mirror beside the telephone booth.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING KIT

Your manner: Elegant, cool and impossible to embarrass. Answer awkward questions with a small smile.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Share: at 11:55 you were at the lobby mirror, and Charlie Ashby was in the telephone booth right beside you, reading a column down the line.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

Share: you heard Charlie say “Gus is selling the club!” into the telephone. If anyone asks about the engagement, say only: “I said no. That was five years ago.”

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

Admit the brooch if pressed: you wanted it back, nothing more. Ask Leslie Croft whether the brooch is mentioned in the will.

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

Suspect quick list (public information only)

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Inspector Sloane Whitaker	The host	Running the investigation
Augustus "Gus" Whitlock	The victim	Owner of the Blue Lantern Club



NO. 14 OF 16

Taylor Moss

THE STAGE MAGICIAN

“You can make a coin vanish. Can you make suspicion vanish too?”

FOR TAYLOR MOSS'S EYES ONLY

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A tailcoat, a top hat, a red silk handkerchief and a deck of cards.

MASK: Harlequin

DRESS STYLE

A sequined jacket over a black dress, a top hat and a deck of cards.

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You perform close-up magic: cards, coins and the occasional vanishing coupe. Tonight Gus hired you to do tricks at the tables.

YOUR SECRET

Your famous “Midnight Blackout” stage act works by unscrewing a fuse. Last year at the Gilded Owl the act went wrong and Morgan Bellamy banned you. Gus knew, and joked tonight that “Taylor could put the lights out any time”.

You are innocent

From 11:45 until after the lights came back you were dealing card tricks at table 4, beside the tower, for Sidney Hart and a crowd of guests.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING TAYLOR

Your manner: Playful and mysterious. Produce a card from behind someone’s ear and answer questions with riddles.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Do a little trick for someone. Share: you heard no click from the bandstand when the lights went out, so it wasn't the stage switch.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

Explain, as an expert: an unscrewed fuse (Evidence 1) needs no skill at all, just five seconds and an empty corridor. Anyone could do it.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

Admit your Midnight Blackout act if asked. Point out that you were dealing cards at table 4 in front of a crowd, Sidney Hart included.

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

Suspect quick list (public information only)

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Sidney Hart	Gus's Ward and Heir	Named in Gus's new will
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Emery Fontaine	The Dance Instructor	Not on the dance floor at 11:58
Marion Kettle	The Club Chef	Keeps the greenhouse key in the kitchen
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Augustus "Gus" Whitlock	The victim	Owner of the Blue Lantern Club



NO. 15 OF 16

Emery Fontaine

THE DANCE INSTRUCTOR

“You taught half the room the Charleston. Where were you at 11:58?”

FOR EMERY FONTAINE’S EYES ONLY

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

High-waisted trousers, braces, a crisp shirt and polished dancing shoes.

MASK: Black lace

DRESS STYLE

A fringe dress made for the Charleston, a beaded headband and T-strap shoes.

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You teach the Charleston and the foxtrot at the Blue Lantern on Thursday nights. Tonight you led the Last Waltz at 11:30.

YOUR SECRET

Morgan Bellamy has offered you a job teaching at the Gilded Owl. At 11:50 you slipped out onto the terrace to think it over, because Gus once said anyone who worked for Morgan would never set foot in the Blue Lantern again.

You are innocent

From 11:50 until the lights came back you were alone on the terrace, looking at the moon.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING EMERY

Your manner: Graceful, energetic and always moving. Invite people to dance and count steps under your breath.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Invite someone to dance. Avoid saying where you were at 11:58 for now.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

Admit you were on the terrace. Share: as you came back in at 11:59, you saw a guest in a peacock mask stepping away from the potted palm by the corridor door, straightening a glove.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

Admit Morgan's job offer if asked. Suggest everyone check the coat-check ledger to see whose mask was the peacock.

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

Suspect quick list (public information only)

NAME	ROLE	TALK OF THE PARTY
Remy Quill	The Art Dealer	Sold Gus the seascapes in his gallery
Avery Lark	The Resident Singer	Contract about to be cancelled by Gus
Jordan Pierce	The Club Partner	Would lose everything if the club was sold
Sidney Hart	Gus's Ward and Heir	Named in Gus's new will
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NO. 16 OF 16

Marion Kettle

THE CLUB CHEF

“The kitchen sees everything, and the greenhouse key hangs on your wall.”

FOR MARION KETTLE’S EYES ONLY

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

Chef’s whites, a tall toque and a tea towel over one shoulder.

DRESS STYLE

A white chef’s jacket over a dark skirt, a neat headscarf and a wooden spoon.

MASK: None (kitchen staff)

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You run the kitchen at the Blue Lantern. The greenhouse behind the kitchen grows your herbs, and its key hangs on a hook by your stove.

YOUR SECRET

You have been selling the greenhouse's best herbs to the Gilded Owl's kitchen on the side. Gus found out on Friday and told you to stop or leave.

You are innocent

From 11:30 until after midnight you were in the kitchen with your two assistants, plating the midnight supper.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
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- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING MARION

Your manner: Warm, busy and a little flustered: the midnight supper is going cold! Offer everyone something to eat.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Share: the greenhouse key hangs on a hook by your stove, and you signed the visitors' book at 7:45 to fetch herbs. Everything was fine then.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

Share: at 8:35 Remy Quill came into the kitchen to borrow the greenhouse key “to sketch the orchids”, and brought it back at about 9:05. You never saw a sketchbook.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

Share: when the key came back, the fingertips of Remy's white gloves looked green. Admit the herb sales if asked.

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

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